

the others. Overall gaming experience was not so great, thanks to the limited resolution and the 5:4 aspect ratio, but then this is not a monitor for gamers anyway. Viewing angles across movies, games and text were quite good. In DisplayMate test, the 16 ramp test had a slight greenish tinge in the black-to-white transition. Reverse text readability was also quite good with only green on cyan and white on yellow being illegible. HD movie viewing experience was good with deep blacks, great skin tone and hardly any backlight bleed.

Acer G195HQ had the second-best contrast ratio, but the DisplayMate performance was a bit lacking. Reverse text test gave poor results and there was a green cast in the grey transition test. HD movie viewing experience was good but there was a fair amount of noise in some scenes like in the clip 'Caves', where a scene inside caves is shown.

Mercury 1950TWG performed quite poorly in the DisplayMate tests with red

and yellow casts in the 16-ramp test, poor colour gamut in the 256-ramp test with prominent banding. Even HD movie clips showed prominent banding in dark scenes.

Intex 1810W and 1811W gave poor contrast ratios. DisplayMate test performance was also not so good. The 1811W gave mediocre grey transitions whereas the 1810W had a strong green cast in this test. Reverse text test was poor in both the monitors. HD movie viewing experience was satisfactory. Noise was very prominent in the dark scenes. FarCry 2 and Resident Evil 5 appeared too flat and the overall experience was bad.

TechCom 1805 had some issues with calculating the contrast ratio. At 100 per cent brightness there was a heavy backlight bleed and the calibrated output had a strong blue cast. We had to reduce the brightness to get legible calibration. Thus its overall contrast ratio score was the lowest. DisplayMate tests such as the reverse text and grey transition tests gave

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mediocre scores. HD movie viewing experience lacked punch and we noticed prominent banding and grains in many scenes.

20-INCHES

This segment had some variety in terms of design, aspect ratios and native resolutions. The AOC e2043Fsk has a native resolution of 1600x1200, while the two other monitors (Acer S201HL and Intex 2011W) have a widescreen resolution of 1600x900.

The AOC e2043Fsk is a really slim LED-backlit LCD monitor and it has the VESA screw mount points on the underside of the base stand, giving you the option of wall mounting it using the base stand. The stem connecting the base to the screen panel is a bit thin and the monitor tends to wobble a lot when slightly nudged. Also we noticed that it's a bit hard to rotate the swivel. The e2043Fsk has a touch-enabled control panel on the

front portion of the base stand having a proximity sensor. On the rear side, the stand has the D-Sub port. OSD usability is just about OK. One thing that we found irritating about the OSD is that it highlights the Exit menu option by default, so you have to constantly go back and forth if you accidentally came out of the OSD.

Acer S201HL is an LED-backlit LCD monitor with a very stiff stand which allows limited swivelling. The plastic quality of the bezel is quite poor though the stand is sturdy. A translucent projection acts as the power switch and glows blue when the monitor is on. OSD buttons are laid out under the base of the bezel, but you'll not need to memorise their functions as you get virtual tags on the screen when the OSD is active.

Intex 2011W is a decent looking monitor with a transparent stem (which is characteristic of Samsung monitors) and a thin bezel. The



Alienware OptX AW2210 still has no competition in terms of looks, across all the categories